

Release What You Are Carrying

Allow approximately an hour to an hour and a half. This is not a timed exercise. Nothing here is graded. If something feels too large, write only a general word such as “grief,” “harm,” or “something for professional support.”

Release is not silence about harm: entrusting an outcome to God does not mean withdrawing a report, abandoning a safety plan, cancelling a boundary, concealing wrongdoing, or relieving an offender of accountability. You do not need to wait for another session to seek protection or support.

1 · What I am carrying (do not sort it yet)

1. How long is the list? Did it surprise you?

2. Which item on it has been there longest?

3. Which item most affects your daily capacity? What kind of support, change, or faithful response might make it more manageable?

3 · Silence

Fifteen minutes, or the length you can manage. Anchor phrase: “Come to me, and I will give you rest.” Or: “Gentle and lowly in heart.” Do not work on the list during the silence.

4 • Journal: sorting the list

Mark each item on your list with one or more letters. "A/E" might mean take the action that belongs to me and entrust the result.

Mark	Meaning	Question to ask
A • Act	Something within my responsibility or control	What is the next faithful action?
S • Share	A burden needing practical, pastoral, relational, or professional support	Who should help carry this?
E • Entrust	An outcome or choice I cannot control	What am I trying to guarantee that belongs to God or to another person?
? • Seek counsel	Responsibility is unclear or potentially serious	Whose qualified wisdom do I need?

1. Look at the items marked E. What have you been trying to guarantee? Where did the sense that it was yours to guarantee come from?

2. Look at the items marked S. For each, name the kind of help it needs: a friend, a spouse, a pastor, a doctor, a counsellor, a colleague, a professional service.

3. Look at the items marked ?. For each, name the right kind of guidance. A pastor or counsellor is not the correct authority for every burden; some need a doctor or mental-health professional, a domestic-abuse specialist, a safeguarding leader, a lawyer or financial adviser, an employer or HR representative, or a trusted family member.

4. Was anything on the list laid on you in God's name that Jesus might describe as a heavy burden, hard to bear? Write about it honestly. If you are not sure, say so.

6 • Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

I have come to Christ, who gives rest.

I release my demand to control what is beyond me.

I will seek help with what should be shared.

I will take the next faithful step in what belongs to me.

Christ is gentle and humble in heart, and I am learning his way.

5 · HANDING OVER: CARDS TO CUT OUT

One card per item. Read each card to God. Place the Entrust cards face down somewhere set apart; keep the others for Session 10.

ENTRUST “I cannot control _____. I release my demand to guarantee the outcome. Show me any faithful action that still belongs to me.”	SHARE “I need help carrying _____. The person or service I will approach is _____.”
ACT “The next faithful step within my responsibility is _____. I do not have to solve everything today.”	SEEK-COUNSEL “I will not make this decision alone. I will seek appropriate guidance from _____.”
ENTRUST “I cannot control _____. I release my demand to guarantee the outcome. Show me any faithful action that still belongs to me.”	SHARE “I need help carrying _____. The person or service I will approach is _____.”
ACT “The next faithful step within my responsibility is _____. I do not have to solve everything today.”	SEEK-COUNSEL “I will not make this decision alone. I will seek appropriate guidance from _____.”